

GLOBAL WEEK AHEAD

The weekend companion to the Daily Need to Know

Everything coming up. Week of Mon 27 July 2026. All times GMT+8.

Prepared Sunday 26 July 2026 (Hong Kong). Forward-looking; for a sophisticated private-market reader. *Verify live prices and confirm scheduled times before acting.*

1 | Setup snapshot — where we closed Friday

Friday 24 July 2026 cash closes and the read into the Monday Asia open. Levels are directional — **confirm live before acting.**

Instrument	Fri 24-Jul close	Session	Into Monday
S&P 500	7,411.98	+0.05%	Flat finish; chip drag vs. defensives. Futures steady Sun night.
Nasdaq Composite	24,975.82	-0.64%	Semis the sore spot (SanDisk -11%); capex angst into MSFT/META.
Dow Jones	51,947.25	+0.46% (+236)	Value/defensive bid; best relative of the majors.
US 10Y yield	4.67%	lower	Bid on Iran/haven flows; FOMC & GDP the pivots.
US 2Y yield	~3.90% (confirm)	rangebound	Anchored to a hawkish-hold Fed at 3.50–3.75%.
DXY (Dollar Index)	~100.9 (confirm)	firm	Haven bid vs. hawkish ECB/BoJ; two-way into FOMC.
Gold (spot)	~\$4,030/oz	below \$4,100	Consolidating under record zone ahead of the Fed.
Silver	confirm live	—	Track gold/industrial pull; oil-shock crosswinds.
Brent crude	\$98.38	-2.3%	Off the >\$100 spike; Hormuz/Red Sea risk premium live.
WTI crude	\$92.19	lower	Same war premium; supply-shock tail still fat.
Bitcoin	~\$65,760	+1.1%	~\$65.3k Asia session; "Clarity Act" + Fed-hold bid.

Sources: CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Washington Post, Bloomberg, Trading Economics (24 Jul 2026). 2Y, DXY, silver and VIX levels flagged for live confirmation.

2 | TL;DR

The whole week bends around one 48-hour window. The FOMC decision (Thu 30 Jul, 02:00 GMT+8) — a hawkish hold expected at 3.50–3.75% under Chair Warsh, no dot plot — collides with the mega-cap gauntlet (MSFT & META Thu; AAPL & AMZN Fri) and the Q2 GDP + PCE prints (Thu night). Overlaid: a live oil/Iran shock with Brent hovering near \$100 and the Strait of Hormuz in play. **Watch:** this is a two-tail week — an AI-capex wobble or a hawkish Warsh could snap the S&P's record streak, while a dovish tilt + clean earnings extends it. Keep risk small into Wednesday night.

3 | The big picture — what to watch

1. The Fed: a hawkish hold, with a hike whispered

FOMC decides **Wed 29 Jul (US) — 02:00 GMT+8 Thu 30 Jul**; Chair **Warsh** presser 02:30. Consensus (FactSet) and prediction markets favour a hold at 3.50–3.75% — Polymarket/futures ~80–95% no-change, but a stubborn ~1-in-3 tail prices a hike. No Summary of Economic Projections this meeting, so the statement wording and Warsh's "prices are too high" framing carry the tape.

Watch: The 2Y and front-end SOFR for any hawkish repricing. A "we are not pre-committing" Warsh keeps the dollar bid and caps duration; any nod to the softening labour data (57k June payrolls) is the dovish release valve for equities and gold.

2. Mega-cap earnings: AI capex on trial

Four of the Mag-7 report into the Fed: **Microsoft & Meta after the Wed close (~04:00–05:00 GMT+8 Thu), Apple & Amazon after the Thu close (~04:00–05:00 GMT+8 Fri)**. After soft Alphabet/Tesla reactions, the market is hunting for capex discipline and cloud/AI monetisation, not just beats.

Watch: Guidance on **AI capex** and Azure/AWS growth is the swing factor for the whole Nasdaq. A "spend more, monetise later" tone risks a semis-led drawdown; evidence of ROI re-rates the complex. Options imply outsized single-stock moves — hedge index beta.

3. The growth-inflation double-header: Q2 GDP + PCE

Advance **Q2 GDP** and the **PCE price data** land **Thu 30 Jul, 20:30 GMT+8** — hours after the Fed. This is the cleanest read yet on whether the oil shock is bleeding into a stagflationary mix (cooling growth, sticky prices). June headline CPI printed **~3.5–4.2%** depending on source; core PCE is the Fed's tell.

Watch: A hot PCE + soft GDP combo is the stagflation signature — bearish for long duration and cyclical, bullish for gold and the dollar. A benign PCE hands the doves the mic.

4. The oil/Iran risk premium

Brent slipped back to **\$98** Friday but the war premium is intact: the 2026 Iran war, Houthi Red Sea strikes, and **Strait of Hormuz** headlines (>20% of seaborne oil) keep a fat supply-shock tail. Any Hormuz/Bab-al-Mandeb escalation is an instant risk-off catalyst.

Watch: Brent \$100 is the psychological line. A break-and-hold above re-arms the inflation trade and pressures the Fed's hawkish hold; a de-escalation headline is the fastest tailwind for equities and bonds.

5. BoJ & China data into the Asia bell

The **Bank of Japan** concludes **Fri 31 Jul** — hold at **1.00%** expected after June's 31-year-high hike, with upgraded FY26 GDP (~0.8%). China's **official NBS PMIs (Fri 31 Jul, 09:30 GMT+8)** set the Asia risk tone.

Watch: A hawkish BoJ "tactical pause" narrative keeps USD/JPY and JGBs jumpy; a sub-50 China manufacturing PMI weighs on commodities and the AUD/regional beta at the Monday–Friday Asia opens.

6. Month-end mechanics

Fri 31 Jul is **month-end**: rebalancing flows, the **Employment Cost Index (Q2)**, and a bunched Eurozone flash CPI/GDP slate can amplify moves into an already event-heavy close. July has been a record-setting month for the S&P — streak protection vs. profit-taking is the tension.

Watch: Pension/index rebalance flows can overwhelm fundamentals on the 31st. Expect elevated closing-auction volume; fade or follow with tight risk.

4 | Economic calendar — the week ahead (GMT+8)

Key global releases, Mon–Fri. US times converted from ET (+12h). **Confirm exact release times on a live calendar** — some prints (PCE split, Eurozone flash) are date-sensitive and flagged.

Day (GMT+8)	Release	Consensus / prior	Why it matters
Mon 27 Jul	US Durable Goods (Jun); Dallas Fed mfg	confirm	Capex demand pulse before the mega-cap prints.
Tue 28 Jul	CB Consumer Confidence (22:00); JOLTS (22:00)	Conf. ~ mid-90s; JOLTS ~8.0m	Labour demand + household mood into the Fed.
Wed 29 Jul	ADP payrolls (20:15); Adv. goods trade; FOMC begins	confirm	Private-jobs warm-up for the Fed decision.
Thu 30 Jul	FOMC decision 02:00 ; Warsh presser 02:30	Hold 3.50–3.75%	The week's fulcrum; no SEP, so wording is everything.
Thu 30 Jul	Q2 GDP (adv.) + PCE prices ; jobless claims — 20:30	GDP softening; core PCE sticky	Growth-inflation mix; the stagflation tell.
Fri 31 Jul	Employment Cost Index (Q2) ; Jun Personal Income/PCE; Chicago PMI; Michigan final	confirm	Wage pressure + month-end; late-cycle read.
Fri 31 Jul	NBS Manufacturing & Non-Mfg PMI — 09:30	Mfg near 50 breakeven	Sets Asia risk tone; commodity/AUD beta.
Fri 31 Jul	BoJ decision (~late morning); Tokyo CPI, IP	Hold 1.00%	USD/JPY & JGB driver; hike-path guidance.
Fri 31 Jul	flash HICP & Q2 GDP (confirm date)	HICP ~2.8% area	ECB September-hike debate; EUR direction.

5 | Central banks & policy events

Central bank	Event (GMT+8)	Expectation	The market's question
US Federal Reserve	Decision Thu 30 Jul 02:00; presser 02:30	3.50–3.75%	How hawkish is Warsh? Any 2026 hike still live?
Bank of Japan	Decision Fri 31 Jul; Outlook Report	1.00%	Is the pause tactical? FY26 GDP upgrade path.
ECB (context)	No meeting — held 23 Jul at 2.25%	2.25%	Lagarde flagged a possible Sept move; watch HICP.

No BoE decision this week (next MPC is early August — confirm). **Fed is the only scheduled G3 decision that moves the world tape this week.**

6 | Earnings on deck

The heaviest week of Q2 season — ~40% of the S&P by weight reports. Dates are US calendar; after-close prints hit the Asia tape the following morning. **Confirm each date/time with company IR.**

US date	Company	What the market wants
Mon 27 Jul		Tone-setter before the mega-caps.
Tue 28 Jul	Visa (V), Coca-Cola (KO), Boeing (BA), PayPal, +many	Payments volume; staples pricing power; BA cash burn/deliveries.
Wed 29 Jul	Microsoft (MSFT) & Meta (META) — after close	Azure growth + AI capex; Meta ad strength vs. capex guide.
Thu 30 Jul	Apple (AAPL) & Amazon (AMZN) — after close; Exxon (XOM), Chevron (CVX) (confirm)	iPhone/services + China; AWS margin; energy cash returns on high oil.
Fri 31 Jul		Supermajor FCF at Brent ~\$100.

Read: The four mega-caps (MSFT, META, AAPL, AMZN) plus GDP/PCE and the Fed all land in ~48 hours. Single-stock implied moves are large — this is an index-hedge, small-size week, not a hero-trade week.

7 | Catalysts & events

- **Month-end (Fri 31 Jul):** index rebalancing, closing-auction flows, ECI + Eurozone slate — mechanical volatility layered on macro.
- **Crypto/regulation:** "Clarity Act" momentum cited behind Bitcoin's push above \$65k — watch for legislative/ETF-flow headlines.
- **Energy/OPEC+ chatter:** any production or Hormuz-security headlines move the whole inflation complex intraday.
- **Options/expiry:** post-July-opex positioning; heavy single-stock gamma around the mega-cap prints.

No major scheduled index reconstitution this week; confirm any late-breaking regulatory deadlines on a live catalyst calendar.

8 | Rates, currencies & commodities

- **Rates:** US 10Y ~4.67% — haven-bid but pinned by a hawkish Fed. Watch a 2Y break higher on any Warsh hawkishness; curve stays the recession/stagflation debate.
- **USD (DXY ~100.9):** haven + rate-differential bid vs. a hold-mode ECB/BoJ. FOMC is the two-way risk; a dovish tilt caps the dollar and helps EM/gold.
- **Gold ~\$4,030:** consolidating below records; the stagflation/haven hedge. A hot PCE or Hormuz escalation is the upside trigger; a hawkish real-rate push is the drag.
- **Oil (Brent \$98 / WTI \$92):** war premium intact. \$100 Brent is the pivot; supply-shock tail keeps energy the key macro swing factor.
- **Crypto (BTC ~\$65.7k):** trading with the Fed-hold/soft-inflation narrative and regulatory catalysts; high-beta risk proxy into the mega-cap week.

9 | Hedgeye risk ranges & regime

Regime map for the week. **Directional**, drawn from the most recent verified Hedgeye commentary (July 2026); the hedgeye-daily-digest feed was not live for this run. Treat ranges as a framework — **confirm current levels in the live Hedgeye product before acting.**

Quad regime

Hedgeye's call has been **Quad 3 (growth slowing, inflation re-accelerating)** — a stagflationary "flation-now, stag-on-a-lag" mix amplified by the oil shock. Quad 3 playbook favours **gold, energy/commodities, and long-duration Treasuries as growth fades**, and cautions on high-multiple growth and cyclicals. The oil-shock overlay pulls toward **Quad 3→4 risk** if growth rolls faster than inflation cools.

Immediate-term risk ranges (framework — confirm live)

Instrument	Ref. level (24 Jul)	Immediate-term range*	TREND
S&P 500	7,412	Buy low / sell high of range	Bullish TREND, stretched
Nasdaq (Comp.)	24,976	Wider band on capex risk	Bullish TREND, fragile
US 10Y yield	4.67%	Lower-end bias on haven bid	Neutral/lower
Gold	~\$4,030	Rangebound ±5% under records	Bullish TREND
Brent	\$98	\$90s with \$100 pivot	Bullish TREND (war premium)
Bitcoin	~\$65.7k	High-beta, wide band	Bullish TREND

**Hedgeye publishes precise numeric buy/sell bands daily; the above are directional placeholders pending the live feed.*

Where we sit / what would change the regime

We sit **late-cycle and stretched**: equities at/near records on a Bullish TREND but into a stagflationary Quad 3 with a fat oil tail. **What flips it:** (1) a hawkish Warsh + hot PCE that pushes real rates up — bearish gold and growth, dollar-positive; (2) an AI-capex disappointment from the mega-caps that cracks the Nasdaq TREND; (3) a Hormuz escalation that spikes Brent through \$100 and hard-confirms the inflation quad. A dovish Fed + clean earnings + oil de-escalation is the bullish counter that extends the streak.

10 | Positioning & themes

- **Crowded/stretched:** mega-cap AI/semis leadership and the record S&P streak — concentration risk is the market's single biggest tell into four mega-cap prints.
- **Volatility:** the "July vol storm" was fading pre-event, but FOMC + GDP/PCE + mega-caps in 48h is a classic vol-of-vol setup. **Confirm VIX live** — expect a pre-Fed bid and post-event crush if outcomes are benign.
- **Credit:** watch IG/HY spreads for any stress on a hawkish surprise or capex scare; benign credit = dip-buyable equity.
- **Tells to watch:** semis (SOX) leadership, the 2Y on Fed wording, Brent \$100, USD/JPY on BoJ, and closing-auction volume into month-end.

11 | Geopolitics — what's live

The **2026 Iran war** remains the dominant macro overlay. Live threads into the week: Houthi Red Sea/**Bab-al-Mandeb** blockade threats, reported Iranian fire toward Jordan/Kuwait, and recurring **Strait of Hormuz** closure risk — the transmission belt from geopolitics to oil to the Fed's inflation problem.

- Any **Hormuz/Red Sea escalation** = instant risk-off, Brent >\$100, bid to gold/USD/Treasuries.
- Any **de-escalation/ceasefire headline** = fastest tailwind for equities and duration; fades the inflation trade.

Prediction markets: Polymarket Fed-July "no change" swung between ~74% and ~95% through the week (Bitcoin/inflation-driven), settling ~80–85% into the meeting. **Confirm live Polymarket/Kalshi odds** for Fed path and any Iran-conflict/Hormuz markets before positioning.

12 | Asia setup — Monday open

Asia likely opens **cautious-to-mixed** Monday: Wall Street's Friday was a split tape (Dow up, Nasdaq down) and futures were steady over the weekend, so no strong directional handoff. With the **Fed, mega-cap earnings and GDP/PCE all mid-to-late week**, expect **low-**

conviction, range-bound trade early as desks de-risk ahead of Wednesday night. Intraday tells: **oil at the open** (Brent vs. \$100), **USD/JPY** into the Fri BoJ, **semis/SOX sympathy** from the US chip rout, and any weekend Hormuz/Iran headlines. China names trade the Fri NBS PMI in anticipation.

13 | Beyond the markets — coming up

- **Policy/summits:** watch for scheduled Fed/central-bank speaker follow-ups and any Middle East diplomacy or OPEC+ chatter — confirm on a live calendar.
- **Space:** a busy late-July launch cadence (SpaceX Starlink/Falcon 9 and other providers) is typical — confirm live launch schedules.
- **Sport & culture:** peak northern-summer season — confirm marquee fixtures/festivals for the week; low direct market impact but consumer-sentiment colour.
- **Product/releases:** mega-cap earnings double as product-signal events (AI features, devices, cloud) — the week's real "launches" are on the earnings calls.

Items in this section are directional placeholders — confirm specific dates on live schedules.

Sources & caveats

Compiled from: CNBC, Reuters, Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, The Washington Post, TheStreet, Kiplinger, IG, Forbes, CBS News, Chase, FXStreet, Trading Economics, Investing.com / Forex Factory economic calendars, Conference Board, Eurostat, CGTN/Nikkei, Polymarket, Hedgeye (July 2026 commentary), and company investor-relations pages (Microsoft, Apple, Amazon, Meta, Visa, Boeing, Coca-Cola, Exxon, Chevron).

All times GMT+8. Levels (2Y, DXY, silver, VIX), some print splits (PCE, Eurozone flash), and Exxon/Chevron earnings timing are flagged for live confirmation. Hedgeye risk ranges are directional pending the live feed. **Verify live prices and confirm scheduled times before acting.**